SIGHT SOUND MOTION · CH 6–11

# Exam 2 — Study Guide

## Film & Aspect Ratio

### Film vs. Video

YES visible difference. Video CAN look more like film in post but can't replicate it.

Q1 **Can video be altered to look more like film in post-production?**
✓ **Yes, it can be made to look more like film but not identical**

### Film Formats

Lower gauge = thicker grain. 16mm thickest → 70mm finest.

| 16mm | 35mm | 65mm | 70mm |
|---|---|---|---|
| Thickest | Fine | V.fine | Finest |

Q2 **Which film format has the THICKEST visible grain when projected theatrically?**
✓ **16mm**

### Aspect Ratios

| 4×3 | 16×9 | 2.35:1 |
|---|---|---|
| 1.33:1 | 1.78:1 | ~7×3 |
| STV | HDTV | Panavision |

4×3 best CU/ECU. 16×9 landscapes. 2.35:1 panoramic but dead zones.

Q3 **What does aspect ratio primarily impact in a film?**
✓ **How events are framed, composed, and perceived**

Q4 **Which aspect ratio is roughly 7×3?**
✓ **2.35:1 (Panavision 35)**

Q5 **Which shot type does 4×3 handle BEST vs. 16×9?**
✓ **Close-ups and ECUs of people**

### Boxing

**Pillarboxing**
Bars: sides

**Letterboxing**
Bars: top/bottom

**Windowboxing**
Bars: all sides

**Pillar=sides. Letter=top/bottom. Window=shrunk+centered (smaller).**

Q6 Pillarboxing places a _____ image into a _____ screen.
✓ **4×3 into 16×9**

Q7 Where do bars appear in letterboxing?
✓ **Top and bottom**

Q8 KEY disadvantage of windowboxing?
✓ **Image reduced in size**

### Secondary Frames

**Artificial masking** Griffith 1916. **Organic** natural elements. **DVE** digital. **Split screen**

Q9 Griffith changed aspect ratio to vertical in 'Intolerance' (1916) using:
✓ **Artificial masking — blacking out both sides**

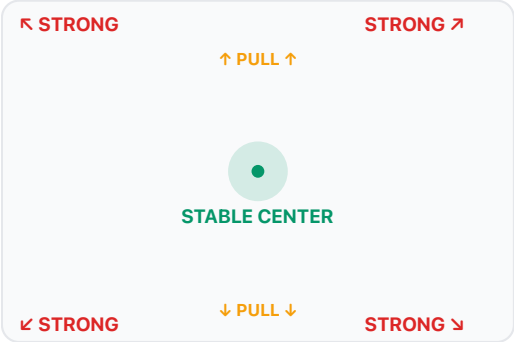
## Size & Screen Forces

### Universal Size Reference

→ **Human being** or hand.

Q10 Universal size reference for establishing object size on screen?
✓ **A human being or parts thereof**

### Magnetism




**Corners strongest**. Center stable. Small→compressed. Large→expands.

Q11 Which screen area exerts STRONGEST magnetic pull?
✓ Corners (combining two edges)

Study Guide | Quiz (48 Qs)

### Headroom

| Too little | Proper | Too much |
|---|---|---|
| Glued top | Eyes upper ⅓ | Bottom-heavy |

**Both CAN intensify.**

Q13 Can headroom manipulation intensify an image?
✓ Yes — deliberate manipulation can intensify

### Graphic Mass

Larger = **more stable**, attracts smaller. Heavy: large, compact, vertical, corner/upper/RIGHT, warm/saturated/dark.

Q14 A larger graphic mass is:
✓ More stable, attracts smaller masses

## Composition & Balance

### Balance Stages

| Static | Dynamic | Unbalanced |
|---|---|---|
| Symmetrical, low tension | Asymmetric, balanced energy | No structure, temporary only |

Q15 Can imbalanced compositions intensify or communicate?
✓ Yes, if temporary and contextually motivated

Q16 In STATIC balance, elements are distributed:
✓ Symmetrically — near-identical both sides

### Rule of Thirds

Place at **intersections**. Golden section variation.

Q17 Rule of thirds: place subjects where?
✓ Where third-lines intersect

### Asymmetry

**RIGHT** gets more attention.

Q18 Which screen side gets MORE attention?
✓ Right

### Diagonals

Q19 Car moving lower-left to upper-right is on which diagonal?
✓ Uphill — diagonal helps pull it up

## Vectors

### Definition

Force with **direction + magnitude**.

Q20 A vector is a force with:
✓ Direction and magnitude

### Types: Motion > Index > Graphic

| Graphic | Index | Motion |
|---|---|---|
| Ambiguous dir | Blurred stills too! | Actually moving |
| LOW | MED | HIGH |

⚡ **Blurred still photo = INDEX, not motion.**

Q21 **Which vector type has HIGHEST magnitude?**
✓ **Motion**

Q22 **A graphic vector's direction is:**
✓ **Ambiguous — either direction**

Q23 **A blurred still photo of a motorcycle in motion is:**
✓ **Index vector — not actually moving**

Q24 **What constitutes a TRUE motion vector?**
✓ **Object actually moving on-screen**

## Noseroom & Leadroom

| NOSEROOM | LEADROOM |
|---|---|
| LOOKING → index | GOING → motion |

Q25 **Noseroom is for ___; leadroom for ___.**
✓ **Index; motion**

## Directions

| → → | → ← | ← → |
|---|---|---|
| Continuing | Converging | Diverging |

Q26 **Two people looking AT each other create:**
✓ **Converging vectors**

Q27 **To make characters in separate CUs look at each other, vectors must:**
✓ **Converge — one screen-R, one screen-L**

## Perception Concepts

### Closure → Gestalt

**Closure** fill gaps. **Gestalt** pattern — whole transcends parts. **Proximity** **Similarity** **Continuity**

Q28 **Pattern from psychological closure is called a:**
✓ **Gestalt**

### Graphication

3D → 2D picture-like via lines, lettering, secondary frames.

🐷 **Piglet = CRISPY BACON**

Q48 **Name of the graphication piglet:**
✓ **Crispy Bacon**

## 3D Field

### Axes

X=width Y=height Z=depth (most flexible, infinite).

Q29 **Z-axis describes which dimension?**
✓ **Depth**

### Depth Planes

| FG | MG | BG |
|---|---|---|

Q30 **Camera zooms IN — foreground plane:**
✓ **May disappear; MG becomes new FG**

### 5 Depth Cues

1. **Overlapping Planes:** Covering = front
2. **Relative Size:** Larger = closer
3. **Height in Plane:** Higher = farther (ı ground)
4. **Linear Perspective:** → vanishing pt, horizon

5 **Aerial Perspective:** FG sharp; BG soft+blue

**Linear persp: camera PARALLEL TO GROUND.**

Q31 Depth cue with lines converging at vanishing point:
✓ **Linear perspective**

Q32 Linear perspective requires camera:
✓ **Parallel to ground, along horizon**

### Volume Duality

**POSITIVE**
Objects/people → crowded

**NEGATIVE**
Bounded space → spacious/isolated

Q38 Interplay of positive and negative volumes:
✓ **Volume duality**

Q39 Dominant NEGATIVE volume makes viewers feel:
✓ **Spacious but potentially isolated**

## Lenses & Depth of Field

### Wide vs. Narrow

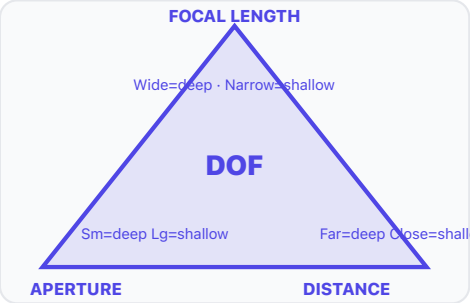
| PROP | WIDE | NARROW |
|---|---|---|
| Z-axis | STRETCHES | COMPRESSES |
| Relative size | + Exaggerates | – Minimizes |
| Linear persp | + Accelerates | – Retards |
| Overlapping | – De-emph | + Emphasizes |
| Aerial persp | – De-emph | + Emphasizes |
| DOF | GREAT | SHALLOW |
| Rack focus | NOT possible | Possible |
| Psych | Power, danger | Crowding, conformity |

Q33 Wide-angle lens makes z-axis appear:
✓ **Elongated — objects farther apart**

Q34 **Does lens choice affect viewers psychologically?**
✓ **Yes — perception, interpretation, feeling**

Q37 **Narrow-angle lens EMPHASIZES:**
✓ **Overlapping planes + aerial persp**

### 3 Things → DOF




Q35 **THREE things affecting depth of field:**
✓ **Focal length, aperture, distance**

### Rack Focus

Change focus during shot. **Shallow DOF → narrow lens.**

Q36 **Changing focus during a shot is called:**
✓ **Rack focus**

## Visualization & Shots

### Shot Sizes

| | |
|---|---|
| ELS | Extreme Long Shot |
| LS | Long Shot |
| MS | Medium Shot |
| MCU | Medium Close-Up |
| CU | Close-Up |
| ECU | Extreme Close-Up |

Q40 **'MCU' stands for:**
✓ **Medium Close-Up**

## Closeness

CU = intimate. **Paraproxemics** .

Q41 **Psychological closeness from shot size relates to:**
✓ **Paraproxemics**

⚡ **O/S = SHOT TYPE, NOT size.**

Q42 **An over-the-shoulder shot is:**
✓ **A shot TYPE / position, NOT a size**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Dutch Angle**<br>Tilted → stress | **POV/Subjective**<br>Through eyes | **4th Wall**<br>Address audience |
| **Superior**<br>Camera UP | **Inferior**<br>Camera DOWN | **30° Rule**<br>Min angle change |

Q43 **Tilted camera creating canted horizon:**
✓ **Dutch angle**

Q44 **Shot through a character's eyes:**
✓ **Subjective camera / POV**

Q45 **Character addresses audience directly:**
✓ **Breaking the fourth wall / direct address**

Q46 **Camera looks UP — character appears:**
✓ **Superior, powerful, authoritative**

Q47 **Min degree difference between shots of same subject:**
✓ **30°**